

holokai-neuron-sdk

SDK for building **Holokai neurons** in Python — connect to a BigBrain gateway over HTTP+SSE and execute capability-typed tasks.

This is the Python sibling of [@holokai/neuron-sdk](#) (TypeScript) and speaks the same wire protocol byte-for-byte (`packages/neuron-protocol`).

Install

```
pip install holokai-neuron-sdk
```

Requires Python 3.10+.

Quick start

```
import asyncio
import logging

from holokai_neuron_sdk import Capability, HandlerContext, Neuron

async def echo(input, ctx: HandlerContext):
    await ctx.progress(percent=50, message="halfway")
    return {"echo": input}

async def main():
    neuron = Neuron(
        gateway_url="https://api.holokai.dev",
        neuron_id="my-neuron-1",
        auth=lambda: "<bearer token>", # sync or async; called per request
        logger=logging.getLogger("neuron"),
    )

    neuron.register_handler(
        Capability(type="example/echo", scope="any", concurrency=4),
        echo,
        input_schema={"type": "object"},
        output_schema={
            "type": "object",
            "properties": {"echo": {}},
            "required": ["echo"],
        },
    )

    await neuron.start()
    try:
        await asyncio.Event().wait() # run until cancelled
    finally:
        await neuron.stop(drain=True, timeout=30)

asyncio.run(main())
```

Concepts

Concept	What it is
Neuron	A process that registers itself with a BigBrain gateway and offers one or more capabilities.
Capability	A namespaced task type (<code>owner/package[/name][.variant]</code>) with a scope (<code>"any"</code> or <code>{onBehalfOf: userId}</code>) and a per-capability concurrency.
Lease	A single in-flight task delivery. Carries the input, schemas, and a deadline. The neuron acks (success), nacks (failure), or progresses.
Cancel	The gateway can revoke a lease mid-flight. The handler's cancellation <code>asyncio.Event</code> is set, the task is cancelled, and a <code>cancelled</code> nack is sent.
Heartbeat	The SDK posts a heartbeat every 10s with the current in-flight lease list. The gateway uses it to detect dead neurons and to renew lease TTLs for long-running tasks.

Wire protocol

- **Transport:** SSE (server → neuron) + HTTPS POST (neuron → server).
- **Endpoints:**
 - `GET /neuron/events?neuronId=...` — SSE stream
 - `POST /neuron/{register, update-capability, heartbeat, ack, nack, progress}`
- **Authentication:** `Authorization: Bearer <jwt>`. The `auth` callback is invoked on every POST and SSE open, and is given one chance to refresh on 401 before the SDK escalates to `reconnect-with-backoff`.
- **Schemas:** input/output JSON Schema arrives on the lease frame; the SDK validates with `jsonschema` and emits a `schema-mismatch` nack on failure.
- **Versioning:** `PROTOCOL_VERSION = "1.0.0"` (free-form on the wire; the gateway negotiates compatibility).

Handler contract

```
async def handler(input, ctx: HandlerContext):
    # ctx.task          – the full task payload
    # ctx.lease_id      – the lease the gateway holds for this delivery
    # ctx.cancelled      – asyncio.Event set on cancel / shutdown
    # ctx.log            – logger scoped to this lease
    # ctx.progress(...) – non-blocking progress update
    # ctx.fail(reason, code=...) – terminal nack (do not catch)
    return {...}
```

- **Sync handlers** are supported; the runner awaits awaitable return values and otherwise treats the return as the result.

- **Cancellation:** handlers wrapping I/O should cooperate with `ctx.cancelled` (e.g. `asyncio.wait` with `[ctx.cancelled.wait(), ...]`).
- **Idempotency** is the handler author's responsibility — the framework does not checkpoint mid-task.

Failure classification

Outcome	Wire kind
Handler returns	<code>ack</code>
Handler raises <code>asyncio.CancelledError</code> (or cancel event set)	<code>nack: cancelled</code>
<code>ctx.fail(...)</code>	<code>nack: terminal</code>
Handler raises any other exception	<code>nack: retryable</code>
Input/output fails JSON Schema	<code>nack: schema-mismatch</code>

Retry policy lives on the workflow (server-side), never on the SDK.

Architecture



- `HttpTransport` owns one SSE stream and a shared `httpx.AsyncClient`.
- `Neuron` wires the transport to a heartbeat loop and a per-capability semaphore-bounded dispatcher.
- `run_lease(...)` validates input, invokes the handler, validates output, and posts the right ack/nack frame.

Examples

Example	Capability	What it does
examples/http_fetch/	<code>examples/http.fetch</code>	Fetches an arbitrary HTTP(S) URL via <code>httpx</code> and returns status/headers/body.
examples/web_search/	<code>examples/web.search</code>	Keyless web search via DuckDuckGo HTML scrape. No API key, but inherently brittle — see the example README for caveats.

Each ships with input/output JSON Schemas, cooperative cancellation (`ctx.cancelled`), and a CLI runner. Run them the same way:

```
pip install -e .
BIGBRAIN_GATEWAY_URL=https://api.holokai.dev \
BIGBRAIN_NEURON_ID=my-python-neuron-1 \
BIGBRAIN_TOKEN=eyJ... \
python -m examples.http_fetch      # or examples.web_search
```

Custom transports

`HttpTransport` is the default but the public `Transport` shape is documented on `TransportCallbacks` and `Neuron(transport=...)` accepts any object that matches the protocol — handy for tests or in-process embeddings.

Tests

```
# Unit + deterministic e2e (default – no network).
pytest

# Network-gated e2e: hits real DuckDuckGo through the real SDK to catch
# scraper drift. Skipped unless explicitly enabled.
E2E_NETWORK=1 pytest -m e2e_network
```

The e2e tests stand up a tiny aiohttp server on loopback that serves both the BigBrain `/neuron/*` surface and a stub for DuckDuckGo, then run the real `Neuron` SDK against it. Every byte flows over real HTTP — SSE in, POSTs out — exercising the full `register → lease → handler → ack` loop. See [tests/e2e/](#).

License

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